

FAQ

Claudia Wells: Are any collaborators materially implicated in the Epstein files? How is this being managed?

Arnaud Delorme: A detailed report is attached to this document.

CW: Is there legal exposure? If so, do we need to consult counsel?

AD: I think you should definitely consult counsel if you have questions.

CW: How significant is the donor or public optics risk? How will we manage it?

AD:

- Code of conduct on the website (strong emphasis on sexual misconduct) – attached in this document
- New donor vetting mechanism – attached in this document
- Advertising the women's conference
- Strong women inclusion (parity)

CW: Does the proceeding align with our stated values?

AD: Yes, we have reviewed [Edgar Mitchell's vision document shared by Dean](#). Edgar's goal was to study psi and help bring it into the mainstream. This is directly aligned with that goal, where psi interacts with mainstream science. It is complementary to the Parapsychology conference, which focuses only on psi. This conference has a wider reach and is larger. The PA conference usually has fewer than 100 participants. We also discussed whether this serves IONS constituents. Many IONS members enjoy these conferences even if they are not scientists, which we saw at the Nanobiosym conference.

CW: Are we documenting our process/due diligence?

AD: Yes, the current document is part of it.

CW: I recommend immediately taking steps with the team to begin compiling these materials for the Board — it doesn't have to take long, but we do need to do it:

Financial pro forma including worst-case reserve exposure.

AD: The budget is included in this document, including worst case scenario.

CW: Written clarity on fundraising commitments and guarantees (if any) from TSC collaborators.

AD: Several pledges have been made and included in this document.

CW: Clear documentation of Board approval prior to operational commitments.

AD: Yes. This document is part of the documentation

CW: Are we clear that Stuart has the authority

AD:

Stuart shared emails from UA, included here, indicating that his department has authority over the conference account. Lori Poloni-Staudinger, Dean of the College of Social and Behavioral Sciences, appears to be the person making the decision regarding the account. The intellectual property of the conference is harder to determine.

Other potential stakeholders included Jay Sanguinetti. He appears to have no access to conference resources or email, although he helped Stuart and is organizing a small version of the conference in Tucson in April for people who could not cancel their tickets. This event is not officially approved or acknowledged.

Another person involved is Dante Lauretta, Stuart's supervisor, who was supposed to take over the conference. However, he has only been involved for two years, whereas Stuart has been involved for 32 years. Both Jay and Dante are at the University of Arizona and appear to have limited room to act because the university will not run the conference. Based on the emails, it appears that Stuart may have the ability to transfer the conference to us.

CW: These were also Cassi's critical dependencies for her decision to participate as co-chair in TSC October before she was asked by her department chair not to participate. (She had not previously agreed, despite Stu's assurances.)

AD: She had agreed, pending a few conditions. Then she backed out because her department was under scrutiny for having Deepak Chopra among its faculty.

CW: I'm seeing securing the long-term support from UCSD as one of the only material ways of "assessing" the impact of the Epstein-related controversy on the reboot and near term future of the conference. If UCSD takes the risk with us it's more likely to be approved.

AD: UCSD has already taken the risk. The email exchanges are included.

CW: How are we following up on a potentially beneficial relationship with the women's conference?

AD: I was on two calls with Julia, who is organizing the conference. I was also on the call for the conference even before we were considering TSC (or at about the same time), out of 3 men among 57 women.